

Enter the Cloud

In the past few years or so, the term ‘cloud computing’ has begun to gain popularity. What ‘cloud’ refers to is simply the collection of hardware and software at the back end that allow you to access specific services. Cloud-based backups are just one of the many services, which are slowly picking up.

Most people are already using cloud storage in some form or the other to create duplicates of their important content. Some are using outdated methods to do this, say, by sending files to their own mail addresses, while others have moved on to newer methods



Data farms – the cloud doing its thing

being offered by cloud storage providers (CSP). In a nutshell, cloud storage is a way of storing files on servers (spread across the world at times) and these files can most often be accessed via some sort of network.

Syncing as value addition

Popular cloud storage providers such as Dropbox and Microsoft SkyDrive already offer data synchronisation to users. You may also be familiar with cloud storage when it comes to email, that’s usually stored in the mail client’s servers. Photos taken by cameras – be it on smartphones or point-and-shoots – can be automatically uploaded to cloud services such as Google Drive for Android devices, OneDrive for Windows Phone and iCloud for Apple. Contacts can be backed up to the cloud and are retrievable using a browser should you lose your contacts due to damage done to the phone. Similarly, desktop users can install one of the many software products provided by CSPs and synchronise their important folders with cloud. The size of common office files doesn’t usually exceed the free storage space provided by CSPs. Additionally with cloud services like Google Drive you can access many common office files (like Microsoft Office’s doc files) using browsers. Then there’s also the ability to save music in the cloud, but many services that allow public sharing have copyright protection in place for